Digital Literacy Portfolio

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Introduction

So, this was my Digital Literacy project, where I had to become a "Student Digital Ambassador" – essentially, someone who helps other students understand the digital world. To be honest, when I first read the assignment brief, I thought it was going to be quite simple, but boy, was I wrong. Through these five tasks, I got to learn everything from how to create visual presentations to the world of cybercrime. What you're going to read here is essentially me writing a report on what I did, what I learned, and how my perceptions changed along the way.

Task 1: Creating My First Infographic

What I Actually Did

For this task, I had to create an infographic about digital literacy. I chose to use PowerPoint because, well, why complicate things? I made one slide with five colorful boxes, each covering a different topic – what is digital literacy, exactly? What tools can we, as students, use? How do we stay safe online? How do we create a professional online presence? And, finally, how do we use email properly. I used different colors for each box – blue, green, red, purple, and orange. And, of course, some emojis for good measure.

The Tool I Used

As I mentioned, I decided on using Microsoft PowerPoint. While it may not be the most hip tool out there, it does get the job done. I had a lot of fun playing around with rounded rectangles, adding colors, and organizing text boxes to ensure everything was nice and organized.

What I Learned

The challenging part was determining how much information was needed without making it look messy. While I was trying to put paragraphs of information inside each box, I came to realize that no one wants to read paragraphs upon paragraphs of information on an infographic. I had to switch gears and use bullet points and phrases instead. While it was harder than I thought to make it look good and make it informative, I suppose it all comes down to compromises.

Task 2: Setting Up My Online Presence

What I Did

The task was all about making professional profiles, and I have created accounts on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. On GitHub, I have created a special repository called README, which appears on your profile page. I have just put my name, mentioned that I am a Computer Science student at VIT Bhopal, and added a line saying I want to know more about programming. For LinkedIn, I have added my education information, and for Kaggle, I have just created an account and am exploring.

What Each Platform is For

GitHub: This is a platform where developers share their codes and work on projects together. I have seen my seniors using it a lot, so I thought I should get on it early. Although my README on GitHub is quite boring right now, I plan on making it better when I actually do some projects.

LinkedIn: This is one of those platforms everyone says you should have when you are looking for jobs or internships. I have added my college information, and that is all I have done on LinkedIn so far.

Kaggle: To be honest, I know nothing about data science, but I have heard this is an important platform for data science, and I am hoping to get into it during my second or third yearn.

My Plan for the Next 4 Years

Looking forward to the future, I think I can make more use of these platforms as I move forward. Currently, in the first year, I am just getting the hang of things. In the second year, I am hoping to have some projects up on GitHub. In the third year, I am hoping to be more active on LinkedIn for internships. And by the final year, hopefully, I can get a good job with the help of all of these. The earlier I start, the better, right? That's what everyone keeps saying anyway.

Task 3: Coding Practice and Google Forms

What I Built

For this task, I hads two thing to do. First, I created a quiz using Google Forms with 5 questions about digital literacy for my batchmates. It has a mix of multiple choice and short answer questions. Second, I was supposed to do a coding challenge on HackerRank or similar platform. I'll be honest - I haven't fully completed the coding part yet, but I've set up my account and I'm working through the beginner exercises.

The Platforms

HackerRank (or similar): I chose thiss because it has structured problem that help you learn step by step. I has completed a simple "Hello Worlda" type problem to get familiar with the interface. It's actually kind of satisfying when your code passe all the test case.

Google Forms: Creating the quizs was pretty straightforward. I made a 5 question covering digital literacy topics. The cool part is that response get automatically collected in a Google Shets, so you can see what everyone answereds.

How This Helps Me

These tools are actually useful for college work. HackerRanks givess me a way to practice coding outside of class assignment, which I definitely need. And Google Forms? I can see myself using that for groups projects to collect opinion or data from classmatess. It's nice when class assignments actually teach you tools you'll use in real life.

Task 4: Writing Professional Emails

The Emails I Wrote

It were interesting becauses, for one, I have not actually ever stopped to thinks about emaisl etiquette before. The two email were one for requesting an extensions for an assignment, and another for requesting a summers internships. The first one was formal, meaning the subjects heading, greeting, paragraphs, and sign-off were formals. The seconds one was formal ass well. While it was a bit weird writing this way, I understands the importance of it..

What I Learned About Email

What I learned was the importance of structure. You cannot just write whatever you want in a professional email. You have to get the point across fast, be polite, and include everything. Another thing is the importance of spelling and grammar. First impressions last, even in an email.

A Story About Bad Digital Communication

For the reflections part, I read this articles about a kids who tweeted some tweets about his professor, which ultimately got him disqualified from his scholarsip. The tweets went virals, and someones showed them to the university, which then disqualified the kids. The thing is, even though he deleteds the tweets, there were still screenshot. The thing is, the kid should have just talked to the professors instead of tweeting. But then again, this is just one of case, and there are many out there who stills do not know the fist thing about this.

Task 5: Learning About Cybercrime

What I Researched

I researched the topsic of cyberbullyings. I wrote a case study on it, discussing what it is, how it happens, who get targeted, and the consequencces of it. I also wrote a list of 8 safetys tips to ensure safety online, of which 2 safetys tips were on UPIs and financial safety, ass it is something each and every ones of us needs to be aware of it. I also ensured I added the detail of the websites and the helpline numbers to report such crimes - the National Cyber Crime Portal website and the 1930 helplines number.

Key Things I Found Out

The stat I came across while researchings were quite surprising. I found out that 37% of youngs peoples have experienced cyberbullying g. And the victims of cyberbullying are twic e as likely to attempt suicides. This is not something to be taken lightly. Cyberbullying is not just kids being kidss. I also found out that victim of cyberbullying can experience it 24/7 through social media , messages, and even gaming. There is just no getting away from it unless you compsletely shut down and disconnects from the word.

What Surprised Me

Honestly, I think it is the fact that UPIs scam are getting so common. I mean, I knew the general safetys measures to be taken online, but I did not know scammer were calling people and pretending to be customer care and getting people to divulge their PIN code. There are like 50,000 cybercrimes complaints filed every month in our country, and most of them are financial frauds. Because of the knowledge I gained through the research, I am definitely going to change one thing - I have been using the same password for everything (I know, I know - lazy, right?), so I am definitelys going to start using a password managers and enabling two-factor authentications for all my accounts.s